

COMMON MISTAKES "FEWER" AND "LESS"

It is important to remember the distinction between countable and uncountable nouns when using "fewer" and "less."

"Fewer" is only used with plural countable nouns.

"Less" is only used with uncountable nouns.



I have **fewer** potatoes than I need. ✓

I have **less** potatoes than I need. ✗

I have **fewer** flour than the recipe requires. ✗

I have **less** flour than I need. ✓



75.10 "MORE THAN," "LESS THAN," AND "FEWER THAN"

"More than" is used when talking about amounts or quantities of countable and uncountable nouns.

Lions eat **more than** 15 pounds of meat each day.



"Fewer than" is used for groups of people or things.

There are **fewer than** 3,500 tigers in the wild.



"Less than" is used when talking about amounts, distances, time, and money.

The wildlife park costs **less than** \$5 to visit.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

The committee holds meetings **more than** 5 times a month.



There were **more than** 100 people at the event.



Charity workers are paid on average **less than** \$10 an hour.



The charity survives with **fewer than** 20 volunteers.



There are **fewer than** 50 tickets left for the charity concert.



You can donate **less than** the recommended amount.

